

CHAPTER FIVE

TRAINING AND DEVELOPMENT

5. Introduction

Training and development are the main functions of the human resource management. Training refers to a systematic setup where employees are instructed and taught matters of technical knowledge related to their jobs. It involves the use of formal processes to impart knowledge and help people to acquire the skills necessary for them to perform their current jobs satisfactorily. It is also the use of systematic and planned instruction activities to promote learning. Learning has happened when people can demonstrate that they know something that they did not know before (insights, realizations as well as facts) and when they can do something they could not do before (skills)'.

Whereas, development refers to the overall holistic and educational growth and maturity of people in managerial positions. It enables people to progress from a present state of understanding and capability to a future state in which higher-level skills, knowledge and competencies are required. It takes the form of learning activities that prepare people to exercise wider or increased responsibilities. It does not concentrate on improving performance in the present job.

Thus, training and development is any attempt to improve current or future performance of employee by increasing an employee's ability to perform through learning, usually by changing the employee's attitude or increasing his or her skills and knowledge.

5.1. Objectives of training and development

Training and development are very important for organizations. It enables an organization to adapt to changes that meet the tastes and preferences of customers. It also improves employees' skills and boosts their morale, thereby making them efficient, reducing waste and operations and increasing productivity. In addition, training and development brings about reduction in employee turnover and results in minimal supervision. Still, it shortens the time for learning by new employees, reduces learning costs, and motivates employees to be loyal to the organization.

Generally, the major purpose of training and development are: -

- Establish sound relationship between the worker and his/ her job
- Upgrade skills and prevent skills obsolescence
- Increase productivity and quality of work
- Improves labor-management relations

- Minimize operational error (wastage, unnecessary repetitions, reduce accident)
- Help address performance deficiencies caused by lack of skills, knowledge and experience

5.2. Process of training and development

The training and development process refers to the stages or steps within a training and development program that ensures the intended objectives can be achieved. According to Desmone, Werner and Harris (2002), there are four stages or steps involved in the training and development process. These are training needs assessment, designing of the training, implementation of the training, and monitoring and evaluation of the training

5.2.1. Training Needs Assessment

Training needs assessment concerns the process of finding out if training is required/needed or not. Three analyses are performed: employee (personal), organizational, and task (job) analyses.

Organization analysis is an examination of the environment, strategies, and resources (technology, financial, and HRM) the firm faces so as to determine what training it should emphasize. The source of data for organizational analysis can be secondary (strategic plan, operational plan, proposed initiatives, financial plan), and Top management

Task analysis involves reviewing the job description and specifications to identify the activities performed in a particular job and the KSAs needed to perform them. I.e., the process of determining what the content of a training program should be on the basis of a study of the tasks and duties involved in the job.

Person/individual analysis involves determining which employees require training and, which do not. Performance appraisal information can be used for the purposes of conducting a person/individual analysis. Source of data can be employee, and immediate supervisor. The purpose of Conducting a person analysis is that it helps organizations avoid the mistake of sending all employees into training when some do not need it, and it can helps to determine training programs

Training needs analysis is used to investigate the educational courses or activities to be given to both employees and management in a bid to enhance their delivery. It is the process of gathering data to train employees in order to meet organizational needs. Training needs analysis is required when there are changes in the system or in the work, when new technology is introduced when new government standards are introduced when there is a decline in the quality of work or performance, when there is a lack of skills and knowledge and when there is lack of motivation.

The methods used to conduct training needs analysis include observation, questionnaires, interviews, focus groups, and documents. If training needs assessment is not carried out, the content, objectives, and methods of the training and development program may be wrong. In addition, costs incurred may be wasted and will not yield the results/ impact expected by the organization. Also, it will not enable the organization to get high-quality labor and increased productivity.

Effective need analysis will lead to:

- Identifying the training goal (what problem the training is hoping to solve?)
- Identifying the training content- what trainees are going to learn
- Identifying The learners' current capabilities
- Identifying the context of the training

5.2.2. Design of the Training and Development

Training and development design concerns the factors or activities included in the training program in a bid to increase the probability that there will be a high degree of transfer of knowledge.

The objective of the training program is derived from the training needs analysis which involves what to be done and achieved. These should be aligned with the mission and vision of the organization . The design of the training and development should be done with views and full participation of management, supervisors and employees.

Training design deals with:

- **Identifying trainees and Setting learning objectives;** - are desired outcomes that the training is intended to achieve. Learning objectives describe the skills or knowledge to be acquired and/or the attitudes to be changed. Example: "At the end of the course, learners will be able to work cooperatively in a small group setting."
- **Identifying Training content;** - Training contents are what the trainees will learn in order to achieve the intended training objectives.
- **Determining the sequencing approach of the content;** - involves how the training material is going to be presented. The sequencing approach can be; -
 - ✓ **Step-by-step sequencing-** Learners are introduced to a task by the steps in the task itself. "first you do this, then you do this."
 - ✓ **Chronological Sequencing-** the content is arranged by time sequence. "first this happened , then this happened."

- ✓ **Whole-to-part sequencing-** Learners are first presented with a complete model or a description of the work duty.
- ✓ **Part-to-whole sequencing-** Learners are presented with each part of a system. then they learn how that part fits into the system as a whole.
- ✓ **Simple-to- Complex sequencing-** content is arranged from simplest task to the most complex task.
- **Identifying trainer/s-** characteristics of effective trainers are:-
 - ✓ Knowledge of subject
 - ✓ Interest in the subject matter
 - ✓ Ability to give Clear instructions
 - ✓ Adaptability – ability to adapt to the different learning ability of trainees.
 - ✓ Individual assistance-When training more than one employee, successful trainers always provide individual assistance
- **Determining training method/s**
 - ✓ Training methods refers to the approach needed to teach specific skills, knowledge and influence attitudes.
 - ✓ A major consideration in choosing among various training methods is determining which ones are appropriate for the KSAs to be learned.

5.2.3. Implementation of Training and Development

Training and development implementation is concerned with starting the training and development program. It is the undertaking of the actual training program. The organization will make sure that the trainers and trainees have reported and are ready to deliver and learn respectively. The program should also start on time as agreed upon.

Resources such as money, vehicles, teaching aids and learning materials are provided and are available to be used. The facilities such as classrooms, furniture, lightening systems, the physical and the general environment should also be conducive to learning.

5.2.4. Monitoring, Evaluation of Training and Development

Monitoring, evaluation is the determination of whether the training program is successful or not in relation to the objectives set and makes recommendations for improvement or change). This involves gathering and analyzing data.

There are two types of training and development evaluation: formative and summative evaluation. Formative evaluation concerns the evaluation that takes place during the training and development design stage to ensure that the training is well organized and whether trainees are content with the program and have learnt from it. It also enables the organization to modify the training content and methods to suit trainees before implementation.

The summative evaluation deals with the evaluation carried out after the training program. The evaluation covers the program from the beginning to the end. It looks at the knowledge, skills, attitudes etc. acquired and their impact, whether it is worth investing in the training program, as well as its general impact on the organization.

The evaluation process involves five stages: conducting needs analysis, developing measurable objectives and analyzing transfer of training, developing outcome measures, choosing an evaluation strategy and planning and executing the evaluation.

Kirkpatrick (1998) has proposed a model of evaluation of training. According to the model, there are four criteria used in training and development evaluation. These include reaction, learning, behaviors and result (or Return on Investment (ROI)

The reaction concerns itself with the post-training attitudes exhibited by employees. This is done to know the reaction of the trainee whether he was content or not with the training methods, the content of the program, the trainers' delivery styles, resources and materials provided.

The second stage, called the learning stage, deals with the measuring of learning acquisition of the trainee. This stage measures the knowledge and skills acquired – and these skills are expected to enhance the performance of the job.

The third level concerns the measurement of the changes emanating from the employee's work-related behaviors and the transfer of knowledge. It deals with how knowledge, skills, and attitudes have been transmitted to the workplace.

The fourth level attempts to measure the results (impact) of the training on the performance of the organization in areas such as productivity, profitability, sales and safety.

5.3. Training methods

Training can be classified under two categories: on-the-job training and off-the-job training. It must be noted that both on-the job training and off-the-job training are genre terminologies for classifications of training and development and not training per se. An organization may decide to training its employees whilst on the job, or off the job. In the case of the former, the worker is

trained inside (internally) the organization. Some of the training and development methods that may be adopted by an organization to upgrade the skills of its employees include apprenticeships, induction and job rotation. For the latter, the employee is trained outside (externally) the organization and training and development methods that may be employed here include simulation, role play and case study.

5.3.1. On-the-Job Training

A. Apprenticeship

Apprenticeship refers to the process whereby a skilled person trains someone who is unskilled. It is also viewed that in apprenticeship, one works and studies at the same time, employing both on-the-job training and classroom training (off-the-job). Generally, the trainee works for and with the trainer who is usually a senior employee and can take a long time. Its main merits include receiving remuneration whilst learning and there is a high degree of securing a job after the training. An organization is likely to get high skilled labor since the training is tailored to meet the organization's needs.

B. Job Rotation

This method refers to the process whereby the trainee learns different types of jobs or functions at different times/periods in an organization. That is, the trainee moves from one function to another as the planned timetable or schedule will dictate. Job rotation refers to the placing of an employee in different positions or situations within a specific period according to the employees' knowledge, skills, and capabilities.

Job rotation is when the trainee moves from one task lateral to another which affords the employee the opportunity to acquire skills. Job rotation enables the trainee to become a multi-skilled employee. In this case, the trainee becomes a generalist after the training since he/she knows a little bit of each task which increases job satisfaction and productivity.

C. Orientation/Induction

It deals with a situation whereby new employees are given the training to enable them to get acquainted with the work and the organization as a whole in respect of values, rules, and regulations. Orientation is a continuous process and takes time for its purpose to be achieved.

Organizations give orientation to their new employees based on three reasons. First, the orientation will afford the new employee the opportunity to acquaint himself/herself with job procedures. The

new employee is also oriented on how to relate with other employees and finally, it makes the new employee feel that he is part of the organization and that his/her job is important.

Generally, orientation is carried out for new entrants on the job to make them familiar with the organization as a whole in terms of structure, objectives, policy etc. One advantage of this method is that it boosts the morale of the employee to deliver without committing grievous errors.

5.3.2. Off-the-Job Training

I. Training Simulation

Simulation refers to the situation whereby the trainee or the employee is trained in a near perfect work situation. It is a training or research method designed to get an experience in a controlled environment.

Simulation concerns training employees in any artificial environment just like the actual work situation whilst vestibule concerns using the prototype or the same equipment just like those used in the workplace for training but the training is conducted outside the workplace.

The vestibule is normally used for training semi-skilled employees and also for training many people at the same time when the equipment is insufficient. Under simulation, trainees operate in an environment similar or exactly as the workplace conditions, both simulation and vestibule are the same and should be used interchangeably.

The main advantage of simulation is that it minimizes the occurrence of training accidents and saves the organization cost and also minimizes the degree of frustration of the trainer since he is not operating in an abstract situation. In addition, simulation enables employees to acquire attitudes, concepts, knowledge, rules or skills to enhance the performance of the trainee.

II. Case Study

A case study is a problem-solving technique in which trainees are given either practical or theoretical issues to analyze, synthesize, solve or ask questions. A case study is adopted by organizations when they want trainees to develop their analytical, problem-solving and critical thinking skills. It is also used when active participation is required and where the learning process involves questioning and interpretations. The learning objective is to have trainees apply known concepts and principles and discover new ones.

III. Role Play

This approach involves the trainee acting and adopting the behavior and attitudes of another person as if he were the real person. The participants of the role play assume the role of imaginary

characters, real people, or just act what they are told to do. The content of the role play can be familiar or strange, simple or elaborate whilst the context can be illustrated in detail or may be vague to give participants the room to use their own creativity and imaginations to act.

This method affords the trainees the opportunity to appreciate and understand others as well as advise others. It is used by managers to deal with conflict, absenteeism and performance appraisal issues.

IV. Classroom/Lecture

Lecture refers to the process whereby a trainer teaches or disseminates information or ideas orally to the trainees with little or no participation by the trainees. The information could emanate from his own reading, research and experiences.

This method is used when many people are taught with a high volume of information or when the content of the training is voluminous. This method can be supported with other training methods like case studies and role playing. The approach is used to cut down cost and it saves time when the trainees are many and when the volume of information is huge.

5.4. Career development

The term **career** has numerous meanings. In popular usage it can mean advancement (“He’s moving up in his career”), a profession (“She’s chosen a career in medicine”), or stability over time (career in the military). For our purposes, we define career as “the pattern of work-related experiences that span the course of a person’s life.”

Using this definition, it is apparent that we all have or will have careers. The concept is as relevant to unskilled laborers as it is to engineers and physicians. For our purposes, therefore, any work, paid or unpaid, pursued over an extended time, can constitute a career. In addition to formal job work, careers can include schoolwork, homemaking, or volunteer work. Furthermore, career success is defined not only objectively, in terms of promotion, but also subjectively, in terms of satisfaction.

5.4.1 Process of Career Development

The word career refers to all types of employment ranging from semi-skilled through skilled, and semiprofessional to professional. The term career has often been restricted to suggest an employment commitment to a single trade skill, profession or business firm for the entire working life of a person. In recent years, however, career now refers to changes or modifications in employment during the foreseeable future.

Career development and the career planning process include a number of specific steps that help to identify personal skills and attributes.

Step 1: Self-Assessment

Evaluating who you are as a person, this involves taking a personal inventory of who you are and identifying your individual values, interests, skills, and personal qualities. What makes you tick as a person? You will look at those personal attributes under a microscope and come up with key qualities you can identify and use in your search for the perfect career. Career assessments may be required to promote a better understanding of personal attributes and skills. Contact your Career Services Office at your college to discuss if a career assessment may be right for you.

Self-Assessment Reality Check Goal Setting Action Planning

Step 2: Research (Career Exploration)

Obtain an insider's perspective about the career field you are considering. Conduct Informational Interviews in person, phone, or by email. Professionals enjoy sharing their expertise with people interested in the field. Perform informational interviews with alumni from your college to gain their perspective of the field and to listen to what they have to say.

Step 3: Decision-Making

Once you've made a thorough self-assessment and have done some research of career options, it's time to make a decision. This can be difficult since there may still be many unknowns and a fear of making the wrong choice. One thing for sure is that although we can do all the necessary steps to making an informed decision, there is no absolute certainty that we are unquestioningly making the right decision. This uncertainty is easier for some people than others but a key point to remember is that you can always learn from any job you have and take those skills and apply them at your next job.

Step 4: Search (Taking Action)

It's now time to look for prospective jobs and/or employers, send out cover letters and resumes, and begin networking with people in the field. Keep in mind that cover letters and resumes are designed to make a favorable impression on employers (if done properly) and the interview process is what will ultimately land you the job. In other words, make sure your cover letter and resume highlight your skills and strengths based on the employer's needs and that you are fully prepared to knock their socks off at the interview. Take time to research the employer's website prior to the interview, and be prepared to ask thoughtful questions based on your research.

Step 5: Acceptance

Learning the skills above will increase your chances of gaining meaningful and satisfactory work as well as help you to avoid many of the stresses that occur with changing jobs. By recognizing that change is good (even advantageous), changing jobs can be viewed as a positive experience and need not be as anxiety provoking as it may initially seem. You will continue the process of self-assessment, research, decision-making, and job searching in order to make effective and fulfilling career changes throughout your lifetime. It is a known fact that most professionals leave an organization due to lack of career growth. Active career development initiatives by a company are a key retention tool to keep the best talent within its fold. It is one of the greatest motivators to keep an employee happy and engaged. But does career planning and development of employees actually make a difference to the productivity of a worker? Most organizations think so, and consider it a part of their critical human resource strategy. From the employees' point of view career development initiatives gives them a clear focus about their career track, the blind spots that they have to overcome and the final goal to be reached. This focused approach works to their advantage from their everyday work to long-term aspirations.

The impact of career development/ succession planning programmes can be seen through the productivity indicator, engagement surveys and reduction in attrition rate. It is in fact a win-win situation for all.

5.4.2 Objective of Career Development

Career Management is the combination of structured planning and the active management choice of one's own professional career. The outcome of successful career management should include personal fulfillment, work/life balance, goal achievement and financial assurance.

The career management process begins with setting goals/objectives. A relatively specific goal/objective must be formulated.

The time horizon for the achievement of the selected goals or objectives - short term, medium term or long term - will have a major influence on their formulation.

- 1) Short term goals (one or two years) are usually specific and limited in scope. Short term goals are easier to formulate. Make sure they are achievable and relate to your longer-term career goals.

- 2) Intermediate goals (3 to 20 years) tend to be less specific and more open ended than short term goals. Both intermediate and long-term goals are more difficult to formulate than short term goals because there are so many unknowns about the future.
- 3) Long term goals (more than 100 years), of course, are the most fluid of all. Lack of life experience and knowledge about potential opportunities and pitfalls make the formulation of long-term goals/ objectives very difficult. Long range goals/objectives, however, may be easily modified as additional information is received without a great loss of career efforts because of experience/knowledge transfer from one career to another.
- 4) Making career choices and decisions – the traditional focus of careers interventions. The changed nature of work means that individuals may now have to revisit this process more frequently now and, in the future, more than in the past.
- 5) Managing the organizational career – concerns the career management tasks of individuals within the workplace, such as decision-making, life-stage transitions, dealing with stress etc.
- 6) Managing ‘boundary less’ careers – refers to skills needed by workers whose employment is beyond the boundaries of a single organization, a work style common among, for example, artists and designers.
- 7) Taking control of one’s personal development – as employers take less responsibility, employees need to take control of their own development in order to maintain and enhance their employability. Career development, as both a field of study and a practical form of training for workers, is primarily concerned with producing better employees and maximizing employee potential.